



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: A Guide to the Night Sky



Learning Outcome

Understand detailed descriptions of real or imaginary events and experiences in present, past or future, in spoken interactions or written texts.

Ask your partner:

- Can you name any stars or constellations? Which ones?
- Can you locate constellations in the night sky? Explain.

Can Do Statements

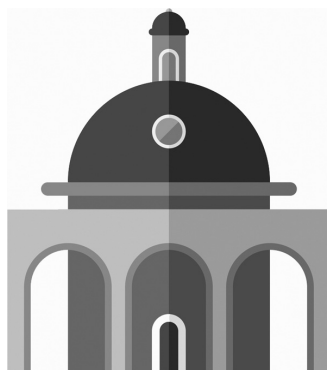
- I can write a paragraph about science.
- I can write about true, untrue and possible events in present and past.
- I can write about reactions and behaviors in different situations.





Let's Explore!

Vanessa and Louise are on a tour of the planetarium. Louise has a lot to learn!



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Tour Guide:** Welcome to our fantastic voyage through the Universe to learn more about our cosmic neighbors.
- Vanessa:** Louise, you really shouldn't use your cellphone on these tours. You'd better switch it off.
- Louise:** It might be my mother though. If I don't answer it, she'll get anxious. Hi, Mom, Yes. I've gotta go, I'm on a tour at the planetarium. Bye.
- Vanessa:** I bet she'll call you again in about an hour. Look at the constellations on the ceiling! Did you know there are 88 of them in total? Their names come from Latin and date back to Greek and Roman times.
- Tour Guide:** It can be difficult to recognize different constellations from a distance so we project the cosmos onto the dome above. Let me point out some interesting features like constellations, planets and ... if you look closely you will see an asteroid.
- Louise:** If I lean back any further I'll strain my neck. How do you know so much about them? What are they used for?
- Vanessa:** They may have been used by farmers to work out the seasons. It also could have been a way of telling which stars are which. I had to do some research on constellations at school. I remember I had to write a paragraph on a couple different ones.
- Louise:** It must have been interesting to learn about the stars. One of the constellations is Orion, right? Aren't the stars part of his belt? I could never find it.
- Vanessa:** Orion is one of the most prominent and recognizable constellations in the sky. If you can't locate this star, you'll need to spend a lot more time gazing into the night sky.
- Louise:** Well ... maybe I'll read your paragraph on Orion then, if you still have it.
- Vanessa:** That was ten years ago! If I still had that assignment in a box somewhere, it would be incredible!



Let's Practice!

Vanessa and Louise consider the origins of the universe.

Instructions: Match the sentences from Column A with the ones on Column B. Write the corresponding letter on the space given.

COLUMN A

1. It might be (___)
2. Louise, you really shouldn't use (___)
3. It can be difficult to recognize (___)
4. They may have (___)
5. It also could have been (___)
6. I bet she'll call (___)
7. It must have been interesting (___)
8. Maybe I (___)

COLUMN B

- a. your cellphone on these tours.
- b. my mother though.
- c. 'll read your paragraph on Orion then, if you still have it?
- d. you again in about an hour.
- e. to learn about the stars.
- f. been used by farmers to work out the seasons.
- g. a way of telling which stars are which.
- h. different constellations from a distance.



Let's Practice!

Vanessa and Louise talk about reactions and behaviors.

Instructions: Write the correct words from the Word bank to complete the sentences. There are 4 extra options that you don't need to use.

Word Bank

need to spend / If I lean back / needs to spend / does you know / If I still had / she get / will you know / she'll get / had still

1. If I don't answer it, _____ anxious.
2. _____ any further I'll strain my neck.
3. If you can't locate this star, you'll _____ a lot more time gazing into the night sky.
4. _____ that assignment in a box somewhere, it would be incredible!
5. If you don't learn about constellations, how _____ what to look for in the sky?



Extension Activity

How much do you know about the stars?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online or to your local library to find information about a constellation in the Southern Hemisphere.
- Take notes about the origin of the name of the constellation, its location and where to look in the sky to find it.
- Write a 150-200 word paragraph using your notes.
- Proofread your work.
- Practice reading the paragraph aloud and check your pronunciation in a dictionary or with your instructor.
- Read your paragraph aloud to a partner and compare your paragraphs.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I research about a constellation.

☐ ☐

I take notes based on research I find online.

☐ ☐

I write a paragraph about a particular constellation.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- voyage** (noun): a long journey to a distant or unknown place
e.g. Welcome to our fantastic voyage through the universe.
- cosmic** (adjective): of or relating to the universe or outer space
e.g. Let's learn more about our cosmic neighbors.
- constellation** (noun): a group of stars that forms a particular shape in the sky and has been given a name
Example: Look at the constellations on the ceiling!
- dome** (noun): a large rounded roof or ceiling that is shaped like half of a ball
e.g. Have you seen the constellations on the dome above?
- prominent** (adjective): easily noticed or seen
e.g. Orion is one of the most prominent and recognizable constellations in the sky.
- to project** (verb): to cause (light, a picture, a movie, etc.) to appear on a surface (used with prepositions onto or on)
e.g. We are able to project the cosmos onto the dome above.





Learning Points

Speculating About the Present

You often guess about situations based on what we know. You can choose modals based on how certain you are about your speculation.

Present

You use modal verbs in a situation when you need to explain a level of certainty in the present.

You use the structures:

must + infinitive

might / might not + infinitive

could / could not + infinitive

may / may not + infinitive

can't + infinitive

Examples:

I think I might need to call my mother back.

I must stop by the gift shop on our way out.

Will / won't

You use **will** and **won't** when we are very sure. This can be in the present, or in the future.

Example:

She'll be at home and thinking of me.

As soon as Ana confirms she's coming, I'll let you know.

Should / shouldn't

You use **should** and **shouldn't** to make assumptions about what is probably true.

Examples:

My mother should be home by now.

It shouldn't be too long now before the tour finishes.





Learning Points

Can

You use **can** for something that is generally possible.

Example:

Tourist areas can be expensive.

When you want to speculate about the **past**, you use the modal + have + the past participle.

Example:

It must have been interesting to learn about the stars.

Examples:

- *It might be my mother though.*
- *It can be difficult to recognize different constellations from a distance.*
- *Louise, the tour shouldn't take long.*
- *I bet she'll call you again in about an hour.*
- *Maybe I'll read your paragraph on Orion then, if you still have it?*

First Conditional

You use first conditional sentences to describe a real situation where the condition can happen.

You use first conditional sentences to talk about things which might happen in the future.

You use the form:

if + **Present Simple**, ... *will* + **infinitive** or **modal** with **infinitive**

Examples:

- *If I don't answer it, she'll get anxious.*
- *If I lean back any further, I'll strain my neck.*
- *If you can't locate this star, you will need to spend a lot more time gazing into the night sky.*

